

UNIVERSITY OF ST. LA SALLE GRADUATE SCHOOL

CONCEPT PAPER

Title: AI-Powered Academic Advising for Graduate Students Using a Conversational Assistant

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Date Submitted: June 15, 2026

1. Background of the Study

Graduate students frequently experience delays in receiving academic guidance regarding enrollment, research milestones, and graduation requirements. While information exists in manuals and handbooks, students often rely on emails or office visits for clarification. This results in slower response times and additional workload for Graduate School staff.

Recent advances in artificial intelligence have enabled conversational assistants that can provide immediate responses based on institutional documents. Such systems may improve student access to information while allowing staff to focus on more complex concerns. Despite the growing use of AI in higher education, limited studies have explored its use for graduate academic advising in Philippine universities.

This study proposes the development of an AI-powered academic advising assistant capable of answering common graduate school questions using approved institutional documents.

2. Statement of the Problem

This study aims to determine the potential of an AI-powered academic advising assistant for graduate students.

Specifically, it seeks to answer the following questions:

1. What advising concerns are most frequently raised by graduate students?
2. How can an AI assistant improve access to academic information?
3. What features should be included in the proposed system?

3. Significance of the Study

- **Graduate Students:** The study may provide faster access to academic information.

- **Graduate School Staff:** The study may reduce repetitive inquiries and improve service efficiency.
- **Future Researchers:** The findings may serve as a reference for future AI-based education systems.

4. Scope and Delimitation

The study focuses on graduate students enrolled during AY 2026-2027. It evaluates academic advising concerns only and excludes financial, admissions, and registrar services.

5. Theoretical Framework

The study is anchored on the Technology Acceptance Model (TAM) by Davis (1989), which explains technology adoption through perceived usefulness and perceived ease of use.

6. Proposed Methodology

Research Design: Descriptive quantitative research.

Participants: 150 graduate students.

Sampling Procedure: Stratified random sampling.

Data Collection Instrument: Online survey questionnaire.

Data Analysis: Frequency, mean, and Pearson correlation.

7. References

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